

Ginger Root Studio

Brand & Business Workbook

WORKING EDITION / OCTOBER 6, 2026



A thoughtful pattern business, rooted in a world you love to draw.

STYLE / COLLECTIONS / DRAWING / PRODUCTION / LICENSING

A practical foundation for a hand-drawn botanical studio: a recognizable visual language, a connected collection library of twelve ranges and 122 print briefs, and a realistic path from a sketchbook to a licensing portfolio.

Built from your shared Surface Pattern Design Roadmap and Christmas collection brief. New recommendations and the drawn visual references in these three books are starting points for your own artwork and decisions, not finished designs.

Three books, one studio

Use the collection guides as a library of possibilities, not a production deadline

BOOK 1 / FOUNDATION AND ACTION

This workbook holds the brand decisions, palette, drawing workflow, production checks and business plan. Pages 3-7 define the studio; pages 8-14 develop the artwork; pages 15-24 turn the work into a manageable practice. Page 25 lists sources and editorial decisions.

BOOK 2 / BOTANICAL & SEASONAL

Six illustrated ranges and 60 print briefs: Harvest Garden, Christmas at the Garden, Winter Garden, The Secret Garden, The Garden Party and Jade Garden. Begin with one range and use its motif library to build related prints.

BOOK 3 / SACRED SEASONS

Six hymn-inspired ranges and 62 print briefs. O Holy Night keeps its earlier twelve-print structure; the other five contain ten prints each. The emotional theme shapes each design without printing lyrics.

ALREADY CHOSEN IN YOUR CONVERSATION

Ginger Root Studio, spelled with spaces. Warm botanical color and flowing hand-drawn detail. Wallpaper, textiles and stationery as the primary products. Adobe Illustrator. Fifteen hours a week. Camellia practice already under way. Half-drop for the lead botanical, a richer but warm palette and finer linework. A recent emphasis on fall and Christmas, with Jade Garden still the signature range.

PROPOSED IN THIS EDITION

The 12-week schedule, business worksheets, collection role assignments, logo directions and visual studies are recommendations. Orchard Sprig and Pinecone Sprig complete two lists that were one design short. The palette has 23 named colors, including Deep Olive, although the original thread called it a 24-color palette. Revenue figures are hypothetical planning inputs, never forecasts.

HOW TO READ A PRINT BRIEF IN BOOKS 2 AND 3

Every design has a stable ID (for example HG01), a working name, a role, its motifs, a composition or repeat direction, one drawing decision and a starting scale study. The standard range is ten designs: 2 heroes + 2 secondaries + 4 coordinates + 1 blender + 1 micro. A hero carries the largest visual story; the second hero needs a genuinely different composition, not a recoloring. A secondary simplifies or isolates a motif family. Coordinates reduce scale, complexity or density. A blender is quiet and low in contrast. A micro uses very small readable marks. O Holy Night is the deliberate exception with 3 heroes, 5 secondaries and 4 coordinates.

YOUR FIRST USEFUL SESSION

Choose Harvest Garden or Jade Garden (page 17). Draw one flower from three angles, add two leaf shapes, then make three small composition thumbnails. Use the first repeat test to discover what you need to draw next. Record the session in the project tracker on page 24.

A NOTE ON THE ILLUSTRATIONS

The concept boards and motif studies in all three books are original vector drawings produced in code for this planning set. They show motif families, hierarchy and repeat structure in the studio palette; they are intentionally simpler than your hand-drawn work will be, and they are not finished or seamless production artwork. Where a drawing differs from a written brief, the brief is correct.

The feeling of Ginger Root Studio

Warm, botanical, graceful, nostalgic and quietly playful

“Hand-drawn botanical patterns for homes and everyday objects, filled with warm color, graceful movement and small stories from nature.”

A WORKING POSITIONING STATEMENT

Use the line above as draft language for a portfolio introduction. It connects the style to wallpaper, textiles and stationery without making the brand depend on a single season or age group. It is draft copy, not an approved tagline.

Visual pillar	How it appears in the work
Botanical character	Rounded flowers, buds, fine stems, layered leaves and carefully observed small creatures: camellia, dahlia, peony, bellflower, sparrow, butterfly, dragonfly.
Graceful movement	S-curves, climbing stems, open arches and interlaced growth. Keep a clear route for the eye through a busy hero; cluster, then release space.
Warm color	Cream and parchment grounds; moss, jade and olive foliage; peach, coral, ochre and berry accents; Blue Willow as the one small cool note.
Human touch	Slightly uneven petals, tapered strokes and restrained painted texture. Some motifs line-only, some lightly painted, some fully painted. Preserve the character of the original drawing.
Quiet storytelling	A bird on a branch, a fallen petal, a star or a lantern. Use the story motif with enough space around it to be noticed.
Influences, held lightly	Art Nouveau movement and color; Korean and East Asian garden structure such as lattice, cloud forms and fans; a slight cottage atmosphere; vintage botanical books and old textiles. Felt, not literal.

THE STYLE TEST

Would this still feel like Ginger Root Studio in one color? Does the silhouette work before the shading? Does the palette feel warm? Is there room for a viewer to rest? Could it live in a home for ten years? If a design feels loud, busy or novelty-driven, cut it.

WHAT THE STUDIO IS NOT

Not generic flat clip art, neon seasonal art, heavy distressing, extremely dark ornate engraving, a highly rustic farmhouse look, or a trendy logo exercise detached from the patterns. The sacred Christmas direction stays heirloom, romantic, reverent and old-world.

MY OWN WORDS FOR THE STUDIO FEELING

One name, three connected families

Organize the portfolio by the story a buyer is looking for

Family	Contents	Purpose
Botanical & Seasonal	Harvest Garden; Christmas at the Garden; Winter Garden; The Secret Garden; The Garden Party; Jade Garden. Six ranges, 60 prints (Book 2).	Everyday and seasonal home, fabric and paper collections. Jade Garden is the signature evergreen range.
Sacred Seasons	O Holy Night; Come Thou Fount; His Eye Is on the Sparrow; Be Thou My Vision; How Great Thou Art; It Is Well. Six ranges, 62 prints (Book 3).	Faith-inspired ranges whose symbols and emotional themes remain connected to nature; translated through meaning and imagery, never printed lyrics.
Children & Story	Future adaptations of selected botanicals, birds, butterflies and quiet narrative motifs from the two families above.	A product direction to test with lighter contrast, open spacing and readable small-scale stories. Not another required set of six collections.

WHAT HOLDS THE FAMILIES TOGETHER

Reuse the same line quality, core greens, warm neutrals and approach to negative space. A bird can move from Jade Garden into a gentler children’s colorway; a vine can support both a seasonal floral and a Sacred Seasons ornament. Stars, sparrows, vines, small shared flowers, sparing gold and a light ground option recur across Sacred Seasons so the six ranges read as one series.

WHAT MAKES EACH COLLECTION DIFFERENT

Give each range one lead flower or landscape form, one clear emotional word and one distinct movement. Change the motif relationships and rhythm along with the palette, so that each collection has its own story rather than the same flower in a different color.

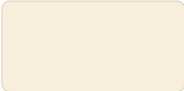
Range	Lead form	Emotional word	Movement
Jade Garden	Camellia	Collected	S-curve vines
Harvest Garden	Dahlia	Gathered	Flowing, interrupted clusters
Christmas at the Garden	Poinsettia and camellia	Festive	Sweeping branch diagonals
Winter Garden	Pale camellia and bare twig	Quiet	Open branch network
The Secret Garden	Peony	Discovered	Curved paths and pockets
The Garden Party	Open summer bloom	Cheerful	Buoyant, airy meadow
O Holy Night	Star of Bethlehem	Wonder	Radiating light, vignettes

MY FIRST FAMILY / FIRST COLLECTION / INTENDED PRODUCT

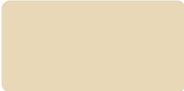
Twenty-three colors, one warm world

RGB / HEX working values; use the companion Adobe Swatch Exchange file

NEUTRALS



Warm Cream
#F7EEDC



Old Parchment
#E9D8B8



Soft Oat
#D8C5A3



Warm Taupe
#9B8064



Soft Cocoa
#76563F



Deep Olive
#596044



Soft Charcoal
#4B4940

BOTANICAL GREENS



Sage
#A5AA82



Moss
#7C865C



Jade
#61765A



Olive Leaf
#85845A



Deep Garden Green
#3F5540

WARM FLORALS



Peach
#F2B18F



Apricot
#E99A68



Warm Coral
#D96F52



Terracotta Rose
#B85E49



Dusty Blush
#D99B8A



Warm Berry
#A94D3D

GOLDEN NOTES



Buttercream
#EED7A4



Warm Gold
#D5A04B



Ochre
#C28A3E



Antique Mustard
#B98232

ONE SMALL BLUE



Blue Willow
#879BA0

The original conversation calls this a 24-color palette but names 23 distinct colors. This edition preserves those 23, including Deep Olive, which one repeated listing dropped. No twenty-fourth color has been invented to make the arithmetic work. The golds are flat color simulations; metallic ink or foil would need separate production instructions.

Treat these numbers as the studio's digital starting point, not a promise of a printed result. Proof the actual material and printing process before approving a production color, and ask each buyer or printer which color mode and profile they want. No CMYK or Pantone equivalents are prescribed here.

COLORS I REACH FOR MOST / COLORS TO USE SPARINGLY

Build a small palette for each range

A focused subset makes related patterns easier to combine

DIRECTION	STARTING SUBSET					
Everyday botanical	 Warm Cream	 Jade	 Sage	 Peach	 Blue Willow	 Soft Cocoa
Spring / summer	 Warm Cream	 Peach	 Warm Coral	 Buttercream	 Moss	 Blue Willow
Autumn	 Old Parchment	 Ochre	 Terracotta Rose	 Warm Berry	 Olive Leaf	 Soft Cocoa
Christmas	 Warm Cream	 Deep Garden Green	 Warm Berry	 Warm Gold	 Soft Cocoa	
Quiet winter	 Warm Cream	 Soft Oat	 Sage	 Blue Willow	 Soft Cocoa	

A SIMPLE BALANCE STUDY

Start with a dominant ground, two foliage colors, two flower or story colors, and one small accent. As a composition exercise, try roughly 60% ground and calm areas, 30% supporting color and 10% emphasis; adjust by eye rather than treating the ratio as a rule. Every collection in Books 2 and 3 names its own seven- or eight-color subset.

LOAD THE INCLUDED .ASE FILE

In Illustrator, open the Swatches panel menu, choose Open Swatch Library > Other Library, then select Ginger_Root_Studio_Master_Palette.ase. Add the colors you need to the current document. The file contains 23 named RGB process swatches with exactly the HEX values on page 5. [A4]

COLOR APPROVAL WORKFLOW

Keep a master palette and record every collection’s subset. Confirm the buyer’s requested color mode and profile before export. Order a sample when the process allows it; compare the printed sample with the design intent under consistent light and note what shifted.

PALETTE ADJUSTMENT AFTER THE FIRST PROOF

A wordmark with room to grow

Five concepts to sketch; these are design directions, not approved or finished logos

	Direction	Drawing brief
	01 / Botanical serif	An elegant, readable serif wordmark with a small hand-drawn leaf. The best starting direction for a warm, established studio feeling.
	02 / Climbing stem	A restrained serif name with one fine vine rising beside it. Keep the stem independent so the name remains legible at small size.
	03 / Root seal	A circular studio stamp with a simple root-and-leaf drawing. Explore as a secondary mark for tags, packaging and the back of a card.
	04 / Garden frame	A loose oval botanical border around the name. Use selectively on presentation covers and labels where there is enough space.
	05 / Lettered signature	A simple custom hand-lettered name with a small, plain STUDIO line. Aim for readable character rather than elaborate flourishes.

The thumbnails in the first column are rough placement sketches made for this page, not drawn logos.

RECOMMENDED FIRST TEST

Sketch directions 01 and 03 in one color. Print each at about 1 inch and 3 inches wide. Keep the spelling and spacing consistent: Ginger Root Studio. Judge the name first; the botanical symbol should support it. Earlier logo images from your conversation were not available to this edition, so nothing here claims to match them.

WORDMARK SKETCH

SECONDARY SEAL SKETCH

A small set of motifs can go a long way

Collect related shapes before building finished repeats

Motif bank	Possibilities across the collection library
Flowers	Camellia, dahlia, peony, chrysanthemum, poinsettia, bellflower, hellebore, simple wildflower, five-petal bloom, water lily, small rose.
Foliage & structure	S-curve vine, broad leaf, narrow leaf, ginkgo fan, oak leaf, holly, evergreen sprig, olive sprig, willow, berry stem, bare branch, reeds, lily pad.
Story details	Garden bird, sparrow, butterfly, dragonfly, strawberry, acorn, pinecone, seed head, eight-point star, small lantern, bell, candle, mountain ridge.

FIRST SESSION: DRAW 8-10 USEFUL PIECES

Choose one lead flower in three views, two leaf types, two curved stems, one bud and one small filler. Draw at a comfortable size on paper first; line only, no color. Save the first version even if it is imperfect; the repeat test will reveal which shapes are missing.

VARIATION THAT FEELS NATURAL

Change the silhouette, opening angle and stem bend. Use mirrored copies only when the lighting and form still make sense. Two independently drawn flower heads usually give a hero more life than many copies of one detailed head. Draw the same camellia once, then let it become a winter, spring, Christmas and garden camellia through color, spacing and companions.

REFERENCE GATHERING

Use your own flower photographs and direct observation for structure. Study historical ornament for rhythm and spacing. For the Korean and East Asian garden influence in your thread, choose specific plants, arrangements or documented references rather than treating a broad region as a single visual style. Generated or drawn references, including the boards in Books 2 and 3, show possibilities; they are not proof of exact botany.

LINE, THEN COLOR

Fine, slightly imperfect, tapered lines first. Then decide per motif whether it stays line-only, lightly painted, fully painted, or painted and detailed with ink. That variation is what makes a pattern feel hand-created rather than vector-generated.

THE NEXT MOTIF MY REPEAT ACTUALLY NEEDS

Continue the flower you already started

Jade Garden / a signature motif that can also support winter and Christmas

OBSERVE THE LARGE SHAPES FIRST

Use a real camellia reference to locate the center, outer cup and overlapping petal groups. Draw the silhouette with five or six broad changes in direction. Add inner petals in loose layers; vary their edges and leave some petals almost unmarked.

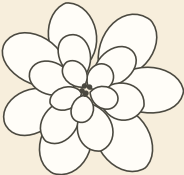
THREE STUDIES

Front view: a rounded flower with an off-center cluster of stamens. Three-quarter view: a cup with shorter far-side petals. Bud: a small oval interrupted by overlapping sepals. Add one broad leaf and one gently curling leaf.

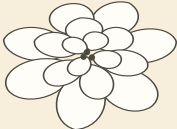
TRANSLATE IT INTO YOUR STYLE

Use the darkest line where petals overlap; lighten the outer edges. Keep veins selective and shading on one side. At thumbnail size, the flower should read as a soft cup before the viewer notices the detail. Tapered stroke ends, consistent weight, no thick outlines, no heavy contouring.

REFERENCE STUDIES DRAWN FOR THIS PAGE / FRONT, THREE-QUARTER, BUD, TWO LEAVES



FRONT



THREE-QUARTER



BUD



BROAD LEAF



CURLING LEAF

MY FRONT VIEW

MY THREE-QUARTER VIEW

MY BUD AND LEAVES

Make Harvest Garden feel like autumn

Begin with structure and rhythm, then add the fine detail

THREE USEFUL DAHLIA DRAWINGS

Front view: a loose circle with staggered petal rings. Side view: a shallow dome with the underside visible. Bud: a compact oval with small layered tips. Keep the petal tips slightly different so the flower feels grown rather than mechanically assembled.

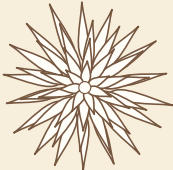
FIRST REPEAT IDEA

Place a large dahlia low on one side and a smaller bloom higher on the other. Connect them with a curved stem. Leave a clear diagonal pocket of background and use an oak leaf or berry cluster to balance it. Build this as a half-drop (page 12).

A 90-MINUTE FIRST SESSION

Minutes	Do this	Outcome
10	Observe two or three real dahlia references; notice the nested petal rings and the uneven center.	A mental map of the structure
30	Three flower studies: front, side and bud. Line only.	Three usable silhouettes
15	Three oak leaves (silhouette first, then the strongest veins), one seed head.	Supporting shapes
20	Three composition thumbnails, each about 2 inches square.	A rhythm to test
15	Choose one thumbnail. Write down the next drawing the repeat needs.	Next session planned

REFERENCE STUDIES DRAWN FOR THIS PAGE / FRONT, SIDE, BUD, OAK LEAF, ACORN



FRONT



SIDE



BUD



OAK LEAF



ACORN

FLOWER STRUCTURE

THUMBNAIL 1

THUMBNAIL 2

THUMBNAIL 3

CHOSEN THUMBNAIL / NEXT DRAWING NEEDED

Keep the hand in the artwork

Choose the conversion method that preserves the drawing's character

Source	Practical approach
Clean line drawings	Place a scan or photograph on a locked reference layer. Redraw the important contours with editable paths. Use fewer, more deliberate anchor points, rounded caps and joins, and test the silhouette with a solid fill.
Image Trace	Place the raster artwork, open Window > Image Trace and try a suitable preset. Inspect corners, small gaps and thin strokes before expanding a copy. Trace can speed conversion, but the result still needs visual judgment and cleanup. [A3]
Painted artwork	Preserve useful watercolor or gouache texture as raster artwork when the intended workflow supports it. Keep a high-resolution source and check effective resolution at the final output size. Vector conversion is a choice, not a requirement for every style.

A TIDY WORKING FILE

Use separate layers for source reference, clean motifs, color studies and repeat development, for example: Background; Florals large; Florals medium; Florals small; Foliage and vines; Details; Repeat guide (locked). Name related objects or groups. Keep an untouched original before recoloring, tracing or expanding strokes.

FROM MOTIFS TO A PATTERN SWATCH

Select the artwork and use Object > Pattern > Make. Adjust the tile in Pattern Options, review enough copies to reveal gaps, then choose Done to save the pattern to Swatches. Test it in a large filled rectangle and export a tile to check, because the live preview is not the final proof. [A1]

DELIVERY COPIES

Expand strokes or flatten only a delivery copy, and only when a buyer needs it; the master stays editable. Ask the actual printer or buyer for color mode, profile, size, resolution and file format instead of assuming one universal export setting.

STOP AND FIX BEFORE MOVING ON

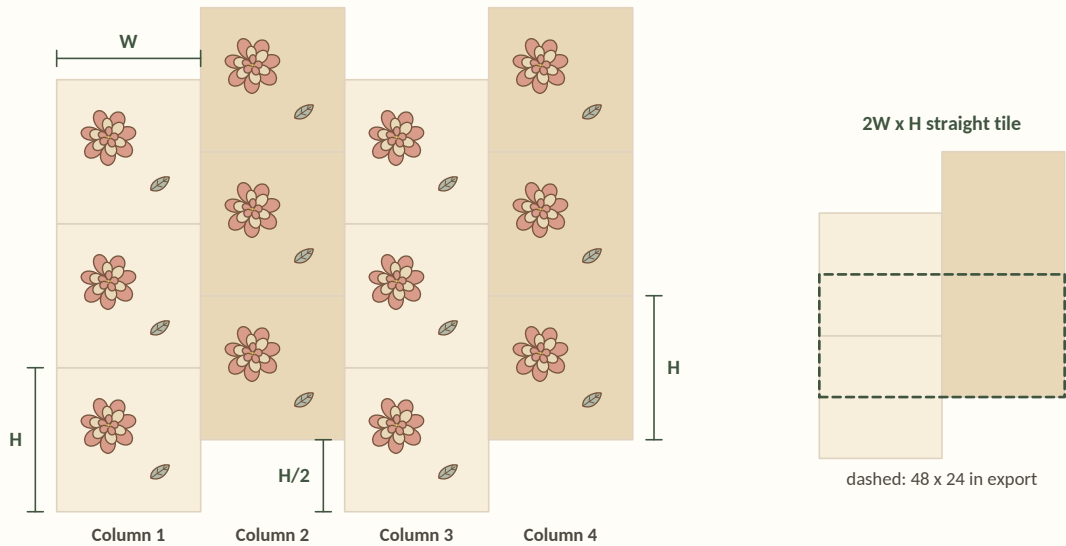
Dense tracing noise, pinhole gaps, doubled strokes, tiny detached shapes, or shading that becomes muddy at the intended print size.

MY CONVERSION TEST / WHAT THE SCAN LOST AND WHAT I REDREW

A true half-drop repeat

Adjacent columns move vertically by half the repeat height

For a tile of width W and height H , the lattice is generated by two translations: the vertical step $(0, H)$ and the column step $(W, H/2)$. Place the next column W to the right and half a tile height up or down. The offset belongs to the entire repeated tile, including all edge-crossing motifs; a half-drop is not made by shifting an arbitrary half of the motifs inside a straight tile.



The same two shapes repeat in every tile. Every other column is shifted by half a tile height. The diagram shows placement geometry, not a finished pattern; it was drawn with exact vector tools, not generated.

EXAMPLE: 24 X 24 INCH BASE TILE

One column step is 24 inches across and 12 inches vertically. One vertical step is 24 inches. A two-column straight-repeat export can use a 48 x 24 inch bounding rectangle, with all boundary-crossing artwork duplicated correctly, then tested as its own tile.

IN ILLUSTRATOR

In Pattern Options, choose Brick by Column and a 1/2 brick offset, then set the width and height. Inspect the actual full preview. Duplicate edge-crossing artwork to the opposite edge of the tile and test the exported tile, not only the live preview. [A2]

PROOF

Inspect at least a 3 x 3 repeat area for accidental diagonals, gaps, clumps, motif collisions and edge mismatches. For a buyer who needs a straight rectangular tile, export and test that tile separately.

MY TILE SIZE / OFFSET / WHAT THE 3 X 3 PROOF REVEALED

Make the artwork easy to review

Keep editable masters and prepare only the deliverables a buyer needs

- ☐ The pattern fills a large rectangle without seams, clipped strokes or missing edge elements; the exported tile was tested, not only the live preview.
- ☐ Motif scale and direction suit the proposed product; a ruler or labeled dimension appears in the proof.
- ☐ Small details remain readable at actual print size. Fine lines have been tested on the intended material.
- ☐ The collection has clear design IDs, names and colorway labels that match the presentation.
- ☐ An editable master is saved with organized layers, linked assets and a version number.
- ☐ The export uses the buyer's requested dimensions, color mode, profile and resolution; nothing was assumed.
- ☐ A separate expanded or flattened copy is supplied only when requested; the master remains editable.
- ☐ The presentation includes the repeat preview, palette, pattern roles and selected product applications.
- ☐ Every preview is labeled honestly: concept, mockup or finished artwork.

SUGGESTED WORKING FILENAMES

GRS_HG01_AutumnGarden_Cream_v01.ai
GRS_HG01_AutumnGarden_Cream_RepeatProof.pdf
GRS_HG_CollectionOverview_v01.pdf

Studio prefix, print ID, working name, colorway and version: a name a buyer can read without opening the file. Keep an untouched master beside every delivery copy.

PRODUCT / REPEAT SIZE / COLOR PROFILE / EXPORT REQUIREMENTS FOR THIS BUYER

Show the same story at different scales

Choose one primary product before creating every possible variation

Application	What to test
Wallpaper	Test a full wall view and a close crop. Check whether large motifs repeat too obviously and whether vertical forms feel natural across seams. Confirm the manufacturer's repeat, panel width and match requirements before fixing the tile size.
Textiles	Test the fabric in the intended use: a dress, quilt, cushion or curtain. Pair a hero with quieter supports. Check directional motifs, cutting loss and whether fine lines survive the fabric texture and dye process.
Stationery	Test the actual item size. A flower that works on a wall may overwhelm a small card. Try a small repeat on an envelope liner, a cropped hero on a notebook, and a micro print on a tag.
Children & story	Try open spacing, gentler contrast and clear bird or butterfly silhouettes. Keep the studio's sophisticated linework so the design grows with the child. Let the product and buyer determine scale instead of assuming every children's design must be tiny.

STARTING SCALE STUDIES USED IN BOOKS 2 AND 3

Role	Starting motif size study	Typical first repeat study
Hero	3-5 in	18-24 in
Secondary	1.5-3 in	12-16 in
Coordinate	0.4-1.2 in	6-12 in
Blender	0.2-0.6 in rhythm	4-8 in
Micro	0.15-0.35 in marks	4-6 in

All motif dimensions in the collection guides are exploratory textile and paper studies, not universal wallpaper specifications. Final repeat size and production specifications depend on the selected product and manufacturer; the O Holy Night briefs carry their own more specific studies.

PRIMARY PRODUCT / INTENDED MOTIF SIZE / FIRST PROOF TO MAKE

A fifteen-hour studio week

Make progress repeatable before making the production target bigger

Work block	Time	Purpose
Drawing & design	7 h	Two focused sessions for motif development and the current hero or supporting print.
Refinement & proofing	3 h	Repeat edges, scale tests, palette cleanup, file organization and a small printed proof.
Buyer research & outreach	3 h	Study relevant product ranges, identify the right submission route, tailor a pitch or follow up.
Planning & administration	2 h	Update the tracker, record expenses and income, back up work and choose the next week's deliverable.
Total	15 h	A starting allocation to revise after two recorded weeks.

PROTECT A MINIMUM FINISHED OUTCOME

Name one concrete deliverable each week: three cleaned camellias, a tested hero repeat, or a collection pitch sheet. Use a “next” list for ideas that arrive while you are finishing the current work. One finished pattern a day and several complete collections in two weeks are not realistic at fifteen hours; the earlier plan that implied them has been replaced.

A REALISTIC FIRST COLLECTION

A ten-print range uses shared drawings. The two heroes need the most attention; coordinates extract smaller ideas from that motif library. Treat the first 12 weeks as a test of your actual pace, then revise the schedule using recorded hours rather than hopes.

A SAMPLE WEEK TO ADAPT

Day	Block	Hours
Mon	Drawing: motifs for the current print	2
Wed	Drawing: hero or supporting print	2
Thu	Drawing, then refinement and proofing	3 + 1
Sat	Proofing, file cleanup, product test	2
Sun	Buyer research, outreach or follow-up	3
Flexible	Planning, tracker, backups	2

THIS WEEK'S FINISHED OUTCOME / MY ACTUAL TIME BLOCKS

One finished collection, ready to show

180 planned hours at 15 hours per week; revise after the first two weeks

Weeks	Main work	Completion evidence	Done
1-2	Choose Harvest Garden or Jade Garden. Draw and digitize a compact 8-10 piece motif library and confirm the palette subset. Build the first hero thumbnails.	Approved direction, palette and 8-10 useful motifs.	☐
3-4	Finish hero 1 and build hero 2 using a genuinely different composition. Start a targeted buyer-fit research list.	Two readable hero repeats and initial product tests.	☐
5-6	Develop two secondary prints and the first two coordinates. Reuse motifs with changed rhythm and scale.	Six related designs with clear roles.	☐
7-8	Finish the remaining coordinates, the blender and the micro. Proof the whole range at two scales.	Ten finished designs with clean repeat proofs.	☐
9-10	Prepare a concise collection presentation, a portfolio page and product applications. Verify submission routes for ten carefully researched prospects.	A shareable portfolio and 10 researched prospects.	☐
11-12	If the artwork is ready, send a small tailored batch; record responses and schedule appropriate follow-up. Improve the portfolio from actual evidence.	Recorded outreach and one clear next improvement.	☐

Aim for five tailored first contacts in the initial outreach batch if the collection is ready. That is a controllable activity target, not a promise of sales or of a deal within any number of days. If the artwork needs longer, adjust the dates and keep the scope focused on one finished range.

HOURS ACTUALLY RECORDED

Week	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Hours												
Main output												

WHAT I WILL CHANGE AFTER WEEK TWO

Use momentum to make the decision

The latest thread favors Harvest Garden; Jade Garden already has sketching momentum

Starting option	Why it may be right now	Immediate action
Harvest Garden (Book 2, page 3)	Choose this if you want to follow the recent fall and Christmas direction and are excited to draw dahlias, autumn leaves and seed heads. It leads naturally into Christmas at the Garden, which shares the cream ground and berry accents.	First session: one dahlia in three views, two oak leaves and three layout thumbnails (page 10).
Jade Garden (Book 2, page 18)	Choose this if your camellia drawings are already developing and you want the studio's evergreen signature range first. The camellia then carries into Winter Garden and Camellia Noel without new drawing.	First session: select the best camellia study, add two buds and a flowing stem, then test a hero layout (page 9).

DECISION RULE

Choose the range you can return to for several weeks. A seasonal theme does not guarantee a near-term buying opportunity; many companies plan seasonal ranges a year or more ahead, so ask each prospect about its development calendar rather than assuming the current season is open. Keep the other range as the next project, with only a small reference folder for now.

EITHER WAY

Both ranges use the same line quality, the same cream ground and the same approach to space, so the motif library you build first will be reused. Finishing one ten-print range well is worth more to a buyer than two half-finished ranges.

I WILL FINISH / BECAUSE / BY THE END OF WEEK

WHAT I WILL POSTPONE UNTIL THIS RANGE IS READY

Make the next conversation easy

A buyer should understand the artwork, product fit and next step quickly

THE INITIAL OFFER

Present a coherent collection available for a defined licensing discussion; that is the emphasis you chose. A custom adaptation or commissioned design can be a separate offer with its own scope, timeline, revisions and fee. Keep print-on-demand experiments optional until the core portfolio is ready. Licensing is your chosen starting point, not a claim that it is universally the easiest or fastest route.

A COMPACT COLLECTION PRESENTATION

Page	Contents
1	Collection name, a large hero, a short story and your contact details.
2	All designs with IDs and roles, plus the named palette subset.
3	Two or three credible product applications and close views that show the drawing quality.
4 (optional)	A second colorway or product-specific variation if it answers a buyer's need.

A PORTFOLIO HOME

Start with a small, organized set of finished work. Give each collection its own overview. Include a short artist introduction, a clear contact route, and an invitation to request the current availability sheet. Label concepts, mockups and finished artwork accurately. A simple site with Home, Collections, About, Licensing and Contact is enough.

BEFORE YOU SHOW A RANGE

Replace the drawn concept boards in Books 2 and 3 with your own finished artwork. Check every preview against the actual repeat file. Keep a record of which designs and product categories are available so the portfolio does not promise rights already committed elsewhere.

MY COLLECTION PRESENTATION WILL INCLUDE

Look for a specific product fit

Research the work a company actually publishes and how it receives submissions

A USEFUL PROSPECT RECORD

Record the company, product category, visual fit, current submission instructions, verified contact or official form, relevant collection, date contacted and next action. Save the source URL and date checked. Prefer a small relevant list to an unfiltered list of names. No real buyer contacts are supplied in this workbook; each entry must come from your own verified research.

THREE QUESTIONS BEFORE A FIRST CONTACT

Does this company use original surface artwork in my product category? Does my collection complement its visual range without duplicating it? Can I identify a legitimate submission route and explain the fit in one sentence?

Prospect / source	Product + fit	Collection / ID	Stage	Next action / date

Stages: researching, ready to contact, sent, follow-up due, conversation, closed or future. A lack of reply is a result to record, not a reason to abandon the style after one batch.

Review submission guidelines before sending files. Tailor the first message and use the requested file size, link or form. Respect each company's stated calendar. No outreach has been sent as part of creating this workbook.

A short, specific introduction

Replace every bracketed field and use the recipient's submission instructions; nothing here has been sent

INITIAL EMAIL DRAFT

Subject: [Collection name] botanical patterns for [product category]

Hello [name],

I'm Alisha, the artist behind Ginger Root Studio. I create hand-drawn botanical patterns with warm color and graceful, nature-inspired details.

I thought my [collection name] range could suit [specific product or reason connected to their work]. It includes [number] coordinating designs featuring [two or three key motifs].

You can view a short collection presentation here: [portfolio link]. If this is relevant to an upcoming range, I'd be happy to share current availability and discuss your artwork needs.

Thank you for your time,

Alisha

Ginger Root Studio | [website] | [email]

FOLLOW-UP DRAFT

Hello [name],

I'm following up on the [collection name] presentation I shared on [date]. Here is the link again: [portfolio link].

If you are reviewing artwork for [product category], I'd welcome the chance to learn what themes or timelines you are considering. If someone else handles submissions, please let me know the appropriate route.

Thank you,

Alisha

Follow the company's stated response window. If none is given, choose a reasonable follow-up date and record it on page 19. Keep the message brief and stop if the recipient declines or asks not to be contacted. The placeholders in brackets are intentional; fill them from your own research.

MY ONE-SENTENCE FIT STATEMENT FOR THIS PROSPECT

Define the arrangement before delivery

Questions to prepare a licensing or custom-work discussion; a planning worksheet, not a contract

Topic	Questions to resolve
Artwork	Which exact design IDs and colorways are included? Are adaptations or new designs part of the scope?
Permitted use	Which products, channels and territories are covered? Is the arrangement exclusive, and if so, within what limits and for how long?
Time	When does use begin and end? What happens at renewal, termination and the end of a sell-off period?
Payment	Is there a fixed fee, royalty, advance or combination? What precisely is the royalty base: retail, wholesale or net sales, and with what deductions? When are statements and payments due? Is an advance recoupable?
Production	Who may alter color or scale? What approvals, samples, file formats and delivery dates are needed?
Ownership & credit	Who owns the original artwork and any new commissioned work? Is any transfer of copyright being requested, and is that intended? What may appear in the artist's portfolio, and when?
Changes & records	How are revisions, cancellations and additional uses handled? Who keeps the signed agreement and the reports?

QUESTIONS FOR THIS PARTICULAR OPPORTUNITY

This is a planning worksheet, not contract language. Have material rights and payment terms documented and reviewed before committing. For U.S. copyright background, including what a transfer or assignment means, see the official resources listed on page 25. [C1] [C2]

Use the \$100,000 goal as a model

Illustrative annual gross revenue; not an earnings forecast, a rate benchmark or a deadline for 2026

The goal in your conversation, \$100,000 “by the end of the year”, is ambitious. This page translates it into assumptions you can test with real opportunities. Keep gross revenue, business expenses, taxes and personal take-home pay separate. The figures below are invented planning inputs, not typical market fees and not a probable result.

Hypothetical source	Assumption	Annual gross
Collection licenses	12 agreements x \$5,000	\$60,000
Custom projects	4 projects x \$7,500	\$30,000
Renewals / extensions	4 agreements x \$2,500	\$10,000
Illustrative total	20 paid agreements / projects	\$100,000

WHAT THE EXAMPLE ACTUALLY ASKS OF THE BUSINESS

Twenty paid agreements in a year from a studio that is still building its first collection. Replace the prices and volumes with the terms of real offers. Count each agreement once; check whether an advance is recoupable before adding it to later royalties as separate revenue.

The time constraint	Arithmetic
Working hours a year	15 hours x 52 weeks = 780 hours
Gross per total working hour	\$100,000 / 780 = about \$128.21
If half the hours are paid-production capacity	390 hours; \$100,000 / 390 = about \$256.41 per production hour
A royalty illustration	At an assumed 5% royalty, \$100,000 requires \$2,000,000 in the contract's defined royalty base before other adjustments.

These ratios describe the required business output; they are not suggested hourly prices. Retail sales, wholesale sales and net sales are not interchangeable royalty bases, and the actual rate, base, exclusions and sales volume would need to come from a real agreement.

FIRST MILESTONE

Finish a strong range, contact relevant buyers and learn from actual responses. Use those facts to revise the revenue model on this page.

MY OWN ASSUMPTIONS TO TEST

Track evidence month by month

Choose any starting month; enter actual amounts as they become known

Use “goal” for the planned figure, “contracted” for agreed fees, “invoiced” for bills issued, and “received” for cash collected. Royalties may arrive later than the product sale, and a recoupable advance is not new income when the royalties that recoup it arrive. Track expenses separately and review the timing of payments as well as the total.

Month	Goal	Contracted	Invoiced	Received	Expenses
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
Total					

WHAT THE ACTUAL NUMBERS CHANGED IN MY PLAN

This worksheet is for planning and recordkeeping. The example on page 22 is an annual aspiration; it is not a promise for the remaining months of 2026.

Finish the ten-print collection

One row per design; tick each stage only when it is proofed, not when it is started

COLLECTION		PRIMARY PRODUCT			
ID	Role / working name	Drawn	Color	Repeat	Proof
01	Hero 1	☐	☐	☐	☐
02	Hero 2	☐	☐	☐	☐
03	Secondary 1	☐	☐	☐	☐
04	Secondary 2	☐	☐	☐	☐
05	Coordinate 1	☐	☐	☐	☐
06	Coordinate 2	☐	☐	☐	☐
07	Coordinate 3	☐	☐	☐	☐
08	Coordinate 4	☐	☐	☐	☐
09	Blender	☐	☐	☐	☐
10	Micro	☐	☐	☐	☐

WEEKLY REVIEW: FINISHED / LEARNED / NEXT USEFUL ACTION

RELEASE CHECK

A recognizable hero, a distinct second hero, quiet supports, consistent color, clean boundaries, readable scale and a concise presentation. For the expanded O Holy Night range, use the twelve-design lineup in Book 3 (page 4) as the tracker: 3 heroes, 5 secondaries and 4 coordinates.

What this edition is built on

Prepared October 6, 2026 / working recommendations for Alisha Bruton

Ref	Source	Used for
S1	Your shared conversation, “Surface Pattern Design Roadmap” (chatgpt.com/share/6ac3b39b-f4cc-83ea-a2f7-72cc6b6d1a59), plus the original O Holy Night brief.	Studio name, style, palette, collections, Illustrator and time budget; confirmed preferences.
A1	Adobe, Create patterns: helpx.adobe.com/illustrator/desktop/paint-and-fill/create-and-edit-patterns/create-patterns.html	Pattern creation and saving to Swatches.
A2	Adobe, Edit patterns: helpx.adobe.com/illustrator/desktop/paint-and-fill/create-and-edit-patterns/edit-patterns.html	Pattern Options controls, brick offset and tile settings.
A3	Adobe, Trace raster artwork: helpx.adobe.com/illustrator/desktop/manage-objects/traces-mockups-symbols/trace-images-to-convert-raster-into-vector-artwork.html	Image Trace workflow and editable vector conversion.
A4	Adobe, Create and open swatch libraries: helpx.adobe.com/in/illustrator/desktop/manage-colors/use-swatches/create-and-open-swatch-libraries.html	Loading the .ase palette.
A5	Adobe, Share swatches between applications: helpx.adobe.com/in/illustrator/desktop/manage-colors/use-swatches/share-swatches-between-applications.html	Swatch exchange background.
C1	U.S. Copyright Office, Visual artists: copyright.gov/engage/visual-artists/	Official starting point for copyright background.
C2	U.S. Copyright Office, Transfers and assignment FAQ: copyright.gov/help/faq/faq-assignment.html	What a transfer or assignment of rights means.

EDITORIAL DECISIONS

This edition uses 23 distinct palette colors; completes the two short collection lists with Orchard Sprig and Pinecone Sprig; retains the earlier twelve-print O Holy Night range inside Sacred Seasons; corrects the half-drop construction; uses the Star of Bethlehem rather than the North Star for the nativity motif; and replaces compressed production promises with a 12-week, 180-hour plan. Revenue examples are explicitly hypothetical. Assistant suggestions in the historical conversation were treated as proposals, not approvals.

ILLUSTRATION AND ARTWORK STATUS

The concept boards and motif studies in Books 2 and 3, the studies on pages 9 and 10 and the cover drawings are original vector illustrations produced in code for this planning set; no photographic or AI-painted imagery was available in the production environment, so the boards are deliberately simple line-and-fill drawings. They visualize direction and hierarchy. They are not Alisha’s existing artwork, not verified seamless tiles and not production-ready licensed collections. Sketch pages invite her own interpretation. The written briefs take priority where an image differs in motif, count or color. Earlier style and logo images from the original conversation were not available and are not reproduced or imitated.

PALETTE AND NEXT DECISIONS

The .ase file encodes the 23 supplied HEX values as named RGB process colors and was decoded and checked after writing. The earlier seven-color standalone Christmas palette is documented in Book 3 as history only and is not included in the file. Choose the first collection, approve its palette and develop original artwork before using any presentation with buyers. No contact information from the screenshots has been reproduced, and no email, pitch or publication has been sent or made.